

Cambridge IELTS 20

Academic Reading Test 1



3 Reading
Passages



40 Questions



60 Minutes

Candidate name:

Test date:

Test Instructions

General Rules

- The test contains three reading passages and 40 questions.
- Allow approximately 20 minutes for each passage.
- Read every instruction carefully before answering.
- Write answers in the spaces provided.
- Check spelling and word limits for completion tasks.
- Transfer and review all answers before the time ends.

Time Plan

01

Passage 1

Questions 1–13 — 20 minutes

02

Passage 2

Questions 14–26 — 20 minutes

03

Passage 3

Questions 27–40 — 20 minutes



Do not turn over until you are told to begin. Manage your time carefully — 20 minutes per passage is recommended.



You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 1–13, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.

The kéképé

The kakapo is a nocturnal, flightless parrot that is critically endangered and one of New Zealand's unique treasures.

The kakapo, also known as the owl parrot, is a large, forest-dwelling bird, with a pale owl-like face. Up to 64 cm in length, it has predominantly yellow-green feathers, forward-facing eyes, a large grey beak, large blue feet, and relatively short wings and tail. It is the world's only flightless parrot, and is also possibly one of the world's longest-living birds, with a reported lifespan of up to 100 years.

Kakapo are solitary birds and tend to occupy the same home range for many years. They forage on the ground and climb high into trees. They often leap from trees and flap their wings, but at best manage a controlled descent to the ground. They are entirely vegetarian, with their diet including the leaves, roots and bark of trees as well as bulbs, and fern fronds.

Kakapo breed in summer and autumn, but only in years when food is plentiful. Males play no part in incubation or chick-rearing – females alone incubate eggs and feed the chicks. The 1-4 eggs are laid in soil, which is repeatedly turned over before and during incubation. The female kakapo has to spend long periods away from the nest searching for food, which leaves the unattended eggs and chicks particularly vulnerable to predators.

Before humans arrived, kakapo were common throughout New Zealand's forests. However, this all changed with the arrival of the first Polynesian settlers about 700 years ago. For the early settlers, the flightless kakapo was easy prey. They ate its meat and used its feathers to make soft cloaks. With them came the Polynesian dog and rat, which also preyed on kakapo. By the time European colonisers arrived in the early 1800s, kakapo had become confined to the central North Island and forested parts of the South Island. The fall in kakapo numbers was accelerated by European colonisation. A great deal of habitat was lost through forest clearance, and introduced species such as deer depleted the remaining forests of food. Other predators such as cats, stoats and two more species of rat were also introduced. The kakapo were in serious trouble.

In 1894, the New Zealand government launched its first attempt to save the kakapo. Conservationist Richard Henry led an effort to relocate several hundred of the birds to predator-free Resolution Island in Fiordland. Unfortunately, the island didn't remain predator free – stoats arrived within six years, eventually destroying the kakapo population. By the mid-1900s, the kakapo was practically a lost species. Only a few clung to life in the most isolated parts of New Zealand.

From 1949 to 1973, the newly formed New Zealand Wildlife Service made over 60 expeditions to find kakapo, focusing mainly on Fiordland. Six were caught, but there were no females amongst them and all but one died within a few months of captivity.

In 1974, a new initiative was launched, and by 1977, 18 more kakapo were found in Fiordland. However, there were still no females. In 1977, a large population of males was spotted in Rakiura – a large island free from stoats, ferrets and weasels. There were about 200 individuals, and in 1980 it was confirmed females were also present. These birds have been the foundation of all subsequent work in managing the species.

Unfortunately, predation by feral cats on Rakiura Island led to a rapid decline in kakapo numbers. As a result, during 1980-97, the surviving population was evacuated to three island sanctuaries: Codfish Island, Maud Island and Little Barrier Island. However, breeding success was hard to achieve. Rats were found to be a major predator of kakapo chicks, and an insufficient number of chicks survived to offset adult mortality. By 1995, although at least 12 chicks had

been produced on the islands, only three had survived.
The kakapo population had dropped to 51 birds.

The critical situation prompted an urgent review of kakapo management in New Zealand. In 1996, a new Recovery Plan was launched, together with a specialist advisory group called the Kakapo Scientific and Technical Advisory Committee and a higher amount of funding. Renewed steps were taken to control predators on the three islands. Cats were eradicated from Little Barrier Island in 1980, and possums were eradicated from Codfish Island by 1986. However, the population did not start to increase until rats were removed from all three islands, and the birds were more intensively managed. This involved moving the birds between islands, supplementary feeding of adults, and rescuing and hand-raising any failing chicks.

After the first five years of the Recovery Plan, the population was on target. By 2000, five new females had been produced, and the total population had grown to 62 birds. For the first time, there was cautious optimism for the future of kakapo, and by June 2020, a total of 210 birds was recorded.

Today, kakapo management continues to be guided by the kakapo Recovery Plan. Its key goals are: minimise the loss of genetic diversity in the kakapo population, restore or maintain sufficient habitat to accommodate the expected increase in the kakapo population, and ensure stakeholders continue to be fully engaged in the preservation of the species.

PART 1 — QUESTIONS

Part 1

Questions 1-6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage?
in boxes on your answer sheet, write

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information
FALSE if the statement contradicts the information
NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

TRUE	if the statement agrees with the information
FALSE	if the statement contradicts the information
NOT GIVEN	if there is no information on this

1 There are other parrots that share the kakapos inability to fly.

2 Adult kakapo produce chicks every year.

3 Adult male kakapo bring food back to nesting females.

4 The Polynesian rat was a greater threat to the kakapo than Polynesian settlers.

5 Kakapo were transferred from Rakiura Island to other locations because they were at risk from feral cats.

6 One Recovery Plan initiative that helped increase the kakapo population size was caring for struggling young birds.

Questions 7-13

Complete the notes below.

Choose **ONE WORD AND/OR NUMBER ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes on your answer sheet.

New Zealand's kakapo

A Type of parrot:

Diet consists of fern fronds, various parts of a tree and **7** 7

Nests are created in **8** 8 where eggs are laid.

Arrival of Polynesian settlers

The **9** 9 of the kakapo were used to make clothes.

Arrival of European colonisers

10 10 were an animal which they introduced that ate the kakapo's food sources.

Protecting kakapo

Richard Henry, a conservationist, tried to protect the kakapo.

A definite sighting of female kakapo on Rakiura Island was reported in the year **11** 11

The Recovery Plan included an increase in **12** 12

A current goal of the Recovery Plan is to maintain the involvement of **13** 13 in kakapo protection.

Passage 2



You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 14–26, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.

To Britain

Mark Rowe investigates attempts to reintroduce elms to Britain

A. Around 25 million elms, accounting for 90% of all elm trees in the UK, died during the 1960s and '70s of Dutch elm disease. In the aftermath, the elm, once so dominant in the British landscape, was largely forgotten. However, there's now hope the elm may be reintroduced to the countryside of central and southern England. Any reintroduction will start from a very low base. 'The impact of the disease is difficult to picture if you hadn't seen what was there before,' says Matt Elliot of the Woodland Trust. 'You look at old photographs from the 1960s and it's only then that you realise the impact elms had. They were significant, large trees then they were gone.'

B. The disease is caused by a fungus that blocks the elms' vascular (water, nutrient and food transport) system, causing branches to wilt and die. A first epidemic, which occurred in the 1920s, gradually died down, but in the '70s a second epidemic was triggered by shipments of elm from Canada. The wood came in the form of logs destined for boat building and its intact bark was perfect for the elm bark beetles that spread the deadly fungus. This time, the beetles carried a much more virulent strain that destroyed the vast majority of British elms.

C. Today, elms still exist in the southern English countryside but mostly only in low hedgerows between fields. 'We have millions of small elms in hedgerows but they get targeted by the beetle as soon as they reach a certain size,' says Karen Russell, co-author of the report *Where we are with elm*. Once the trunk of the elm reaches 10-15 centimetres or so in diameter, it becomes a perfect size for beetles to lay eggs and for the fungus to take hold. Yet mature specimens have been identified, in counties such as Cambridgeshire, that are hundreds of years old, and have mysteriously escaped the epidemic.

The key, Russell says, is to identify and study those trees that have survived and work out why they stood tall when millions of others succumbed. Nevertheless, opportunities are limited as the number of these mature survivors is relatively small. 'What are the reasons for their survival?' asks Russell. 'Avoidance, tolerance, resistance? We don't know where the balance lies between the three. I don't see how it can be entirely down to luck.'

D. For centuries, elm ran a close second to oak as the hardwood tree of choice in Britain and was in many instances the most prominent tree in the landscape. Not only was elm common in European forests, it became a key component of birch, ash and hazel woodlands. The use of elm is thought to go back to the Bronze Age, when it was widely used for tools. Elm was also the preferred material for shields and early swords. In the 18th century, it was planted more widely and its wood was used for items such as storage crates and flooring. It was also suitable for items that experienced high levels of impact and was used to build the keel of the 19th-century sailing ship *Cutty Sark* as well as mining equipment.

E. Given how ingrained elm is in British culture, it's unsurprising the tree has many advocates. Amongst them is Peter Bourne of the National Elm Collection in Brighton. 'I saw Dutch elm disease unfold as a small boy,' he says. 'The elm seemed to be part of rural England, but I remember watching trees just lose their leaves and that really stayed with me.' Today, the city of Brighton's elms total about 17,000. Local factors appear to have contributed to their survival. Strong winds from the sea make it difficult for the determined elm bark beetle to attack this coastal city's elm population. However, the situation is precarious. 'The beetles can just march in if we're not careful, as the threat is right on our doorstep,' says Bourne.

F. Any prospect of the elm returning relies heavily on trees being either resistant to, or tolerant of, the disease. This means a widespread reintroduction would involve existing or new hybrid strains derived from resistant, generally non-native elm species. A new generation of seedlings have been bred and tested to see if they can withstand the fungus by cutting a small slit on the bark and injecting a tiny amount of the pathogen. ‘The effects are very quick,’ says Russell. ‘You return in four to six weeks and trees that are resistant show no symptoms, whereas those that are susceptible show leaf loss and may even have died completely.’

G. All of this raises questions of social acceptance, acknowledges Russell. ‘If we’re putting elm back into the landscape, a small element of it is not native – are we bothered about that?’ For her, the environmental case for reintroducing elm is strong. ‘They will host wildlife, which is a good thing.’ Others are more wary. ‘On the face of it, it seems like a good idea,’ says Elliot. The problem, he suggests, is that, ‘You’re replacing a native species with a horticultural analogue. You’re effectively cloning.’ There’s also the risk of introducing new diseases. Rather than plant new elms, the Woodland Trust emphasises providing space to those elms that have survived independently. ‘Sometimes the best thing you can do is just give nature time to recover over time, you might get resistance,’ says Elliot.

*horticultural analogue: a cultivated plant species that is genetically similar to an existing species.

PART 2 — QUESTIONS

Part 2

Questions 14-18

Reading Passage has seven paragraphs, **A–G**.

Which section contains the following information?

Write the correct letter, **A–G**, in boxes on your answer sheet.

NB You may use any letter more than once.

14 Reference to the research problems that arise from there being only a few surviving large elms

15 Details of a difference of opinion about the value of reintroducing elms to Britain

16 Reference to how Dutch elm disease was brought into Britain

17 A description of the conditions that have enabled a location in Britain to escape Dutch elm disease

18 Reference to the stage at which young elms become vulnerable to Dutch elm disease

Questions 19-23

Look at the following statements and the list of people below.

Match each statement with the correct person, **A, B, or C**.

NB You may use any letter more than once.

List of People:

A. Matt Elliot

B. Karen Russell

C. Peter Bourne

19 If a tree gets infected with Dutch elm disease, the damage rapidly becomes visible

20 It may be better to wait and see if the mature elms that have survived continue to flourish

21 There must be an explanation for the survival of some mature elms

22 We need to be aware that insects carrying Dutch elm disease are not very far away

23 You understand the effect Dutch elm disease has had when you see evidence of how prominent the tree once was

Questions 24-26

Complete the summary below.

Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

Uses of a Popular Tree

For hundreds of years, the only tree that was more popular in Britain than elm was **24** 24 .

Starting in the Bronze Age, many tools were made from elm, and people also used it to make weapons. In the 18th century, it was grown to provide wood for boxes and **25** 25 . Due to its strength, elm was often used for mining equipment, and the Cutty Sark's **26** 26 was also constructed from elm.

Passage 3



You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 27–40, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.

How Stress Affects Our Judgement

Some of the most important decisions of our lives occur while we're feeling stressed and anxious. From medical decisions to financial and professional ones, we are all sometimes required to weigh up information under stressful conditions. But do we become better or worse at processing and using information under such circumstances?

My colleague and I, both neuroscientists, wanted to investigate how the mind operates under stress, so we visited some local fire stations. Firefighters' workdays vary quite a bit. Some are pretty relaxed, they'll spend their time washing the truck, cleaning equipment, cooking meals and reading. Other days can be hectic, with numerous life-threatening incidents to attend to, they'll enter burning homes to rescue trapped residents, and assist with medical emergencies. These ups and downs presented the perfect setting for an experiment on how people's ability to use information changes when they feel under pressure.

We found that perceived threat acted as a trigger for a stress reaction that made the task of processing information easier for the firefighters – but only as long as it conveyed bad news.

This is how we arrived at these results. We asked the firefighters to estimate their likelihood of experiencing 40 different adverse events in their life, such as being involved in an accident or becoming a victim of card fraud. We then gave them either good news (that their likelihood of experiencing these events was lower than they'd thought) or bad news (that it was higher) and asked them to provide new estimates.

People are normally quite optimistic -they will ignore bad news and embrace the good. This is what happened when the firefighters were relaxed, but when they were under stress, a different pattern emerged. Under these conditions, they became hyper-vigilant to bad news, even when it had nothing to do with their job (such as learning that the likelihood of card fraud was higher than they'd thought), and altered their beliefs in response. In contrast, stress didn't change how they responded to good news (such as learning that the likelihood of card fraud was lower than they'd thought).

Back in our lab, we observed the same pattern in students who were told they had to give a surprise public speech, which would be judged by a panel, recorded and posted online. Sure enough, their cortisol levels spiked, their heart rates went up and they suddenly became better at processing unrelated, yet alarming, information about rates of disease and violence.

When we experience stressful events, a physiological change is triggered that causes us to take in warnings and focus on what might go wrong. Brain imaging reveals that this 'switch' is related to a sudden boost in a neural signal important for learning, specifically in response to unexpected warning signs, such as faces expressing fear.

Such neural engineering could have helped prehistoric humans to survive. When our ancestors found themselves surrounded by hungry animals, they would have benefited from an increased ability to team about hazards. In a safe environment, however, it would have been wasteful to be on high alert constantly. So, a neural switch that automatically increases or decreases our ability to process warnings in response to changes in our environment could have been useful. In fact, people with clinical depression and anxiety seem unable to switch away from a state in which they absorb all the negative messages around them.

It is also important to realise that stress travels rapidly from one person to the next. If a co-worker is stressed, we are more likely to tense up and feel stressed ourselves. We don't even need to be in the same room with someone for their emotions to influence our behaviour. Studies show that if we observe positive feeds on social media, such as images of a pink sunset, we are more likely to post uplifting messages ourselves. If we observe negative posts, such as complaints about a long queue at the coffee shop, we will in turn create more negative posts.

In some ways, many of us now live as if we are in danger, constantly ready to tackle demanding emails and text messages, and respond to news alerts and comments on social media. Repeatedly checking your phone, according to a survey conducted by the American Psychological Association, is related to stress. In other words, a pre-programmed physiological reaction, which evolution has equipped us with to help us avoid famished predators, is now being triggered by an online post. Social media posting, according to one study, raises your pulse, makes you sweat, and enlarges your pupils more than most daily activities.

The fact that stress increases the likelihood that we will focus more on alarming messages, together with the fact that it spreads extremely rapidly, can create collective fear that is not always justified. After a stressful public event, such as a natural disaster or major financial crash, there is often a wave of alarming information in traditional and social media, which individuals become very aware of. But that has the effect of exaggerating existing danger. And so, a reliable pattern emerges – stress is triggered, spreading from one person to the next, which temporarily enhances the likelihood that people will take in negative reports, which increases stress further. As a result, trips are cancelled, even if the disaster took place across the globe, stocks are sold, even when holding on is the best thing to do.

The good news, however, is that positive emotions, such as hope, are contagious too, and are powerful in inducing people to act to find solutions. Being aware of the close relationship between people's emotional state and how they process information can help us frame our messages more effectively and become conscientious agents of change.

PART 3 — QUESTIONS

Part 3

Questions 27-30

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C or D**.

Write the correct letter in boxes on your answer sheet.

27 In the first paragraph, the writer introduces the topic of the text by

- A** defining some commonly used terms.
- B** questioning a widely held assumption.
- C** mentioning a challenge faced by everyone.
- D** specifying a situation which makes us most anxious.

28 What point does the writer make about firefighters in the second paragraph?

- A** The regular changes of stress levels in their working lives make them ideal study subjects.
- B** The strategies they use to handle stress are of particular interest to researchers.
- C** The stressful nature of their job is typical of many public service professions.
- D** Their personalities make them especially well-suited to working under stress.

29 What is the writer doing in the fourth paragraph?

- A** Explaining their findings
- B** Justifying their approach
- C** Setting out their objectives
- D** Describing their methodology

30 In the seventh paragraph, the writer describes a mechanism in the brain which

- A** Enables people to respond more quickly to stressful situations.
- B** Results in increased ability to control our levels of anxiety.
- C** Produces heightened sensitivity to indications of external threats.
- D** Is activated when there is a need to communicate a sense of danger.

Questions 31-35

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A-G**, below.

- A** made them feel optimistic.
- B** took relatively little notice of bad news.
- C** responded to negative and positive information in the same way.
- D** were feeling under stress.
- E** put them in a stressful situation.
- F** behaved in a similar manner, regardless of the circumstances.
- G** thought it more likely that they would experience something bad.

31 At times when they were relaxed, the firefighters usually

32 The researchers noted that when the firefighters were stressed, they

33 When the firefighters were told good news, they always

34 The students' cortisol levels and heart rates were affected when the researchers

35 In both experiments, negative information was processed better when the subjects

Questions 36-40

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage?

In boxes on your answer sheet, write

YES if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer

NO if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer

NOT GIVEN if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

YES	if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer
NO	if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer

36 The tone of the content we post on social media tends to reflect the nature of the posts in our feeds.

37 Phones have a greater impact on our stress levels than other electronic media devices.

38 The more we read about a stressful public event on social media, the less able we are to take the information in.

39 Stress created by social media posts can lead us to take unnecessary precautions.

40 Our tendency to be affected by other people's moods can be used in a positive way.

ANSWER KEY

Answer Key & Explanations

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
1	False	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that the kakapo is the only parrot that cannot fly in the whole world, meaning there are no other parrots like it that are also unable to fly. Answer Explanation: The answer is FALSE. This means it is not true that there are other parrots that also cannot fly like the kakapo. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is FALSE because the passage states that the kakapo is the only flightless parrot in the world. It clearly says, "It is the world's only flightless parrot," which means there are no other parrots that cannot fly.
2	False	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that kakapo have babies in the summer and autumn, but they can only do this if there is enough food. This means they do not have chicks every year. Answer Explanation: The answer means that adult kakapo do not have chicks every year. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is FALSE because the passage explains that kakapo only breed in summer and autumn, but only in years when food is plentiful. This means they do not produce chicks every year, only during certain years.
3	False	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that male kakapo do not help with taking care of the eggs or chicks. Only the female kakapo incubates (sits on) the eggs and feeds the young birds.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		Answer Explanation: The answer is FALSE. This means that adult male kakapo do not bring food back to nesting females. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is FALSE because the passage states that 'Males play no part in incubation or chick-rearing - females alone incubate eggs and feed the chicks.' This means the male kakapo do not help the females by bringing them food.
4	Not Given	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that settlers found the kakapo easy to catch and kill, and they also brought rats that hunted the kakapo. However, it does not explain which was more dangerous. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the passage does not say for sure whether the Polynesian rat was a bigger problem for the kakapo than the Polynesian settlers. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is NOT GIVEN because the passage mentions that both Polynesian settlers and the Polynesian rat threatened the kakapo, but it does not compare the level of threat of one over the other. It only states that the settlers hunted the kakapo and that the rats preyed on them, without stating which was the greater threat.
5	True	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage tells us that feral cats were hurting kakapo on Rakiura Island, making their numbers go down quickly. So, the remaining kakapo were moved to three different islands to keep them safe. Answer Explanation: The answer is TRUE. This means that it is correct to say that kakapo were moved from Rakiura Island to other places because feral cats were a danger to them. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is TRUE because the passage explains that predation by feral cats on Rakiura Island caused a fast decrease in kakapo numbers. This situation led to the decision to move the remaining kakapo to island sanctuaries to protect them from these cats.
6	True	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that during the Recovery Plan, people moved kakapo birds to different islands, fed the adult birds extra food, and helped young kakapo that were not strong. This shows that they cared for young birds to help the population grow. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the statement is correct. Caring for young kakapo birds that are not doing well helped the population grow. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is TRUE because the passage mentions that the kakapo Recovery Plan included 'rescuing and hand-raising any failing chicks.' This shows that taking care of young birds was part of the effort to help increase the kakapo population.
7	bulbs	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that kakapo eat only plants. Their food includes leaves, roots, bark, bulbs, and fern fronds. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'bulbs'. This means that kakapo eat parts of plants called bulbs. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'bulbs' because the passage says that the kakapo's diet includes 'the leaves, roots and bark of trees as well as bulbs, and fern fronds.' This shows that bulbs are one of the food types that kakapo eat.
8	soil	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that the kakapo lays its eggs in the ground. This ground is called 'soil', and the mother bird moves the soil while taking care of the eggs.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		Answer Explanation: The answer is 'soil'. This means that the kakapo lays its eggs in the ground. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'soil' because the passage says that the female kakapo lays her eggs in the ground, which is called 'soil'. This shows where they make their nests for the eggs.
9	feathers	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that early settlers could easily catch kakapos because they could not fly. They used the meat for food and took the feathers to make soft jackets. Answer Explanation: The answer 'feathers' means the soft covering on the body of the kakapo parrot. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'feathers' because the passage states that the first Polynesian settlers used the kakapo's feathers to make soft cloaks. This shows that feathers were an important part of the kakapo's value to early settlers.
10	deer	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that many animals lost their homes because forests were cut down. Introduced animals like deer ate the remaining food that other animals, like the kakapo, needed to survive. Answer Explanation: The answer 'deer' means that these animals were brought to New Zealand by people. They caused problems for the kakapo by eating the food that the kakapo needed. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'deer' because the passage explains that when Europeans came to New Zealand, they brought deer. These deer ate the food that the kakapo required to live, which is why they are mentioned as a problem for the kakapo.
11	1980	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that in 1980, people found out that female kakapos were on the island. This was important for helping the kakapo survive. Answer Explanation: The answer is 1980. This was the year when people saw female kakapos on Rakiura Island for the first time after some time. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 1980 because the passage states that in 1977, a large population of males was found, and it was confirmed that females were also present in the year 1980. This is an important event in the recovery of the kakapo population.
12	funding	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that in 1996, they made a new plan to help the kakapo birds. They got more money, or funding, to help with the plan. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'funding'. This means money that is given to help with a project or cause. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'funding' because the passage discusses how a new Recovery Plan for the kakapo was launched in 1996, which included a larger amount of money or funding. This funding was important to help manage and protect the kakapo and its habitat.
13	stakeholders	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that the Recovery Plan has important goals. One goal is to make sure that stakeholders, or the people who care about the kakapo, help to protect it. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'stakeholders'. This means people or groups who have an interest in keeping the kakapo safe.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'stakeholders' because the passage says that one of the goals of the kakapo Recovery Plan is to ensure that stakeholders continue to be involved in the protection of the kakapo. This shows that it's very important for these groups or people to be part of saving the kakapo.
14	C	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that it is hard to study these large elms because there are not many of them left. Answer Explanation: The answer is C. This means that the information about problems with research related to the few large elms that survived can be found in section C. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is C because in section C, it mentions that there are very few mature elm trees left, which makes research about their survival difficult. The section states, 'Nevertheless, opportunities are limited as the number of these mature survivors is relatively small.' This clearly shows that having only a few large elms is a problem for research.
15	G	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says there are different feelings about bringing back elms. Russell thinks it is good because elms can help wildlife. But some people are worried about using trees that are not originally from the area. Answer Explanation: The answer is G. This section talks about different opinions on whether bringing back elms to Britain is a good idea or not. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is G because it describes the debate around reintroducing elms. Some people think it will help the environment, while others are concerned about replacing native species with plants that are similar but not originally from the area. The section presents viewpoints from different people about the benefits and risks of reintroducing elms.
16	B	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that the first time there was a problem with elm trees was in the 1920s. But then, in the 1970s, a new problem started because some elm wood came from Canada. This wood had beetles that spread the disease, making it worse. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'B'. This means that the part of the passage you are looking for is section B. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'B' because this section explains how Dutch elm disease came to Britain. It mentions that the disease was caused by a fungus that was spread by beetles, which came with shipments of elm wood from Canada in the 1970s. This directly relates to the question about how the disease was brought into Britain.
17	E	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that strong winds from the sea help protect the elm trees in Brighton, making it hard for harmful insects, like the elm bark beetle, to harm them. Answer Explanation: The answer means that section 'E' talks about how the elm trees in Brighton were able to survive the Dutch elm disease because of special conditions. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'E' because it describes how factors unique to Brighton, like strong winds, help the elm trees survive against the beetles that spread the disease. The conditions mentioned in the excerpt are important for understanding why the elms in this location were able to escape Dutch elm disease.
18	C	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage tells us that there are many small elms in hedgerows, but when they grow to a certain size, beetles can attack them. This means

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		young elms become vulnerable when they are big enough for the beetles to lay eggs on them. Answer Explanation: The answer is C. This means the information about when young elms can get sick from Dutch elm disease is found in section C. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is C. In this section, it says that small elms stay safe until they reach a trunk size of 10-15 centimeters. After this size, they are more likely to be attacked by beetles that spread the disease. This shows that young elms are vulnerable when they grow to a certain size.
19	B	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that the results of the disease can be seen very soon. After four to six weeks, if a tree is weak, it can lose leaves and might die. This shows that the damage from the disease happens fast. Answer Explanation: The answer is B, which means Karen Russell said that when a tree is sick from Dutch elm disease, you can see the damage quickly. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is B because Karen Russell talks about how you can see the damage to the trees from the disease in a short time. She explains that resistant trees do not show symptoms quickly, while those that are not resistant can show leaf loss and might even die completely. This indicates that damage from the disease appears fast on weak trees.
20	A	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that instead of bringing in new elms, it is better to make space for the elms that are already alive. By doing this and letting nature heal, the trees might become stronger against diseases. Answer Explanation: The answer is A, which means Matt Elliot thinks it's better to wait and let the surviving mature elms grow before doing anything else. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is A because Matt Elliot emphasizes the importance of letting nature take its course. He believes that the best solution might be to give time for the existing elm trees that have survived to recover so that, over time, they can develop resistance to the disease. This means waiting and seeing how these trees do, instead of planting new elms right away.
21	B	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage talks about Karen Russell asking questions about why some mature elms are still alive today, even though many others died from a disease. She mentions three possible reasons: avoidance, tolerance, and resistance. She believes it's not just chance that helped these trees survive. Answer Explanation: The answer says 'B', which means it is Karen Russell who is thinking about why some mature elms survived when so many others did not. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'B' because Karen Russell directly asks about the reasons for the survival of mature elms in the passage. She is trying to figure out if the trees survived because they avoided the disease, were tolerant of it, or were resistant to it. This shows she is focused on understanding their survival.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
22	C	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage means that if we are not careful, the beetles carrying the disease can come very close and cause problems. Bourne says this makes it important to pay attention to the threat. Answer Explanation: The answer is C. This means Peter Bourne is the person who told us to be careful about insects that spread Dutch elm disease being close to us. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is C because Peter Bourne talks about how the elm trees in Brighton are at risk from the beetles carrying the disease. He says, 'The beetles can just march in if we're not careful, as the threat is right on our doorstep.' This shows that we need to be aware of these insects nearby.
23	A	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage talks about how important it is to see old photos to understand how many elms used to be in Britain before they died from the disease. Matt Elliot says that if you haven't seen these photos, it's hard to understand how many trees there were and why it was significant. Answer Explanation: The answer means that Matt Elliot talks about how important elms were in the past. He says that it is hard to understand how much they mattered until you look at old photos that show how many elms there were. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is A because Matt Elliot explains how we can see the impact of Dutch elm disease by looking at old photographs. He mentions that these pictures show how many elms were in Britain before they mostly disappeared due to the disease. This helps us understand the importance of elms in the past.
24	oak	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that for a long time, elm was almost as popular as oak, which was the most preferred hardwood tree in Britain. Answer Explanation: The answer is "oak." This means that oak was the tree that was more popular than elm in Britain. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is "oak" because the passage says that for many years, elm was almost the most popular tree in Britain, but oak was slightly more popular. This is important because it shows the history and significance of these trees in British culture.
25	flooring	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that in the 18th century, people started to plant more elm trees, and the wood from these trees was used to make storage crates and flooring, showing its importance. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'flooring'. This means the wood from the elm tree was used to make the floor in buildings or other places. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'flooring' because the passage talks about how elm wood was used for making storage boxes and also for flooring in the 18th century. This shows that elm was valuable for these kinds of uses.
26	keel	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage tells us that elm wood was strong and used for things that needed to take a lot of force, like the keel of ships and mining tools. Answer Explanation: The answer 'keel' means the bottom part of a ship that helps it stay stable in the water. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'keel' because the passage mentions that elm wood was used to build the keel of the famous sailing ship Cutty Sark. This shows how important elm wood was for making strong and useful parts of boats.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
27	C	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage talks about important decisions we have to make when we feel stressed. It mentions that everyone sometimes needs to think carefully about information when they are under stress. Answer Explanation: The answer suggests that the writer is talking about a problem or challenge that everyone faces, which is making decisions while stressed. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is C because the first paragraph explains that we all have to make important choices, like medical and financial ones, while feeling stress. This shows that facing challenges while making decisions is a common experience for everyone.
28	A	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that the different levels of stress that firefighters experience make it a good situation to study how stress affects how they think and make decisions. Answer Explanation: The answer means that firefighters often have different levels of stress in their jobs. This makes them good people to study how stress affects decision-making. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is A because the passage says that the firefighters experience both calm days and very stressful days. This variation in stress is what makes them ideal for studying how stress affects their ability to process information.
29	D	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage is explaining that the researchers asked firefighters how likely they thought bad things would happen to them. Then, they told the firefighters some good news or bad news to see if this changed their answers. This shows how they did the research. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the writer is showing how they did their research. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'Describing their methodology' because in the fourth paragraph, the writer talks about how they asked firefighters to estimate the likelihood of bad events and how they provided good or bad news to see how this affected their thinking under stress. This shows the specific steps taken in their research.
30	C	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage tells us that when something stressful happens, our bodies change, and we start to notice warnings better. This helps us see what could be dangerous. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the brain makes us notice dangers better when we are stressed. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is C because the passage explains that when we feel stress, our brain changes in a way that makes us focus more on bad news or warnings. This includes things like danger or alarming information. Keywords to pay attention to are 'stress,' 'trigger,' 'warnings,' and 'danger.'
31	B	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that when the firefighters were calm, they acted differently. They did not pay much attention to bad news, but when they were stressed, they started to notice bad news more. Answer Explanation: The answer means that when the firefighters were calm and not stressed, they didn't pay much attention to bad news. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is B because the passage explains that when firefighters were relaxed, they ignored bad news and focused more on good news. This shows that they didn't really take notice of the bad things happening around them.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
32	G	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that when firefighters were under stress, they paid close attention to bad news and changed their thinking about it, believing there was more chance of bad things happening. Answer Explanation: The answer means that when the firefighters were feeling stressed, they believed there was a higher chance they would experience something negative. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is G because the passage explains that when firefighters were under stress, they became very attentive to bad news and changed their opinions to think that the chances of negative events happening to them were higher.
33	F	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that being stressed did not change how the firefighters felt about good news. They reacted the same way, showing that their response was consistent. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the firefighters acted the same way, no matter if they were told good news or bad news. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is F because the passage explains that under stress, the firefighters did not change how they reacted to good news. They maintained a consistent response regardless of whether the news was good or bad.
34	E	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that when the students felt stress, their cortisol levels went up, which means their bodies reacted strongly in a stressful situation. This shows how stress affects them. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the researchers made the students experience a situation that was stressful. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is E because the passage says that the students' cortisol levels and heart rates increased when they were told they had to give a surprise public speech, which was a stressful situation. The stress made them react physically.
35	D	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that when the subjects felt stressed, they paid more attention to negative news, which means they reacted strongly to bad information. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the people in the experiments were feeling stressed. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is D because when the subjects were under stress, they became more aware and responsive to negative information. This is shown in the passage where it explains how stress made the firefighters and students react more to bad news.
36	Yes	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that when we see good things on social media, like pretty sunsets, we often share good things too. But when we see bad things, we tend to share bad things as well. Answer Explanation: The answer means that what we post on social media usually shows similar feelings to what we see in other people's posts. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is YES because the passage explains that our emotions can be influenced by what we see online. It states that if we see positive posts, we are more likely to share positive things too, and if we see negative posts, we will post negative things. This shows that the tone of our posts reflects what we see.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
37	Not Given	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that looking at your phone a lot can lead to stress, but it does not say anything about how phones compare to other devices in causing stress. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'NOT GIVEN,' which means the passage does not say if phones cause more stress than other electronic devices. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'NOT GIVEN' because the passage talks about how checking your phone can cause stress, but it does not compare phones to other electronic devices to say which one has a greater impact on stress levels.
38	No	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that stress can spread between people and that when we feel stressed, we are more likely to notice negative news. This means we can take in more information, but it may be mostly negative. Answer Explanation: The answer 'NO' means that the statement is not correct. It suggests people do not become less able to understand information; instead, they might actually take in more negative information when stressed. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'NO' because the passage states that stress can make people more aware of negative reports, meaning they take in this information better, even if it increases their stress. So, the statement claiming we are less able to take information in is wrong.
39	Yes	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that sometimes people cancel their trips and sell their stocks because they feel scared after hearing bad news, even if that bad news is far away. This shows that stress can make people act in ways that might not be necessary. Answer Explanation: The answer says 'YES', which means that the statement is correct. It tells us that stress from social media can cause us to be overly careful or worried. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'YES' because the passage shows that stress from bad news can create actions like cancelling trips and selling stocks, even if the bad events are not directly affecting us. This means that stress can make us think we need to take extra steps to protect ourselves when, in reality, those actions might not be needed.
40	Yes	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that good feelings, like hope, can be caught by people. This means if one person feels hopeful, it can make others feel the same way and help them to do something positive. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the way other people feel can help us feel good or act positively. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is YES because the passage mentions that positive emotions, like hope, can spread from one person to another and encourage people to take action to find solutions. This shows that we can be influenced in a good way by the feelings of others.